EXAM INVIGILATION PLANNING

Uni-Guard User Guide

Every page and button, step by step, with screenshots.
For admins, schedulers and viewers.

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Uni-Guard User Guide

Every page and button, step by step.

QUICK START

1. Add rooms
2. Add people
3. Set time slots
4. Create an exam period
5. Allocate rooms (optional)
6. Generate the schedule
7. Check it
8. Export & email staff

Uni-Guard plans who supervises each exam room. It matches **people** (chief invigilators and invigilators) to **rooms** in **time slots**, fairly and without clashes.

Words used in this guide

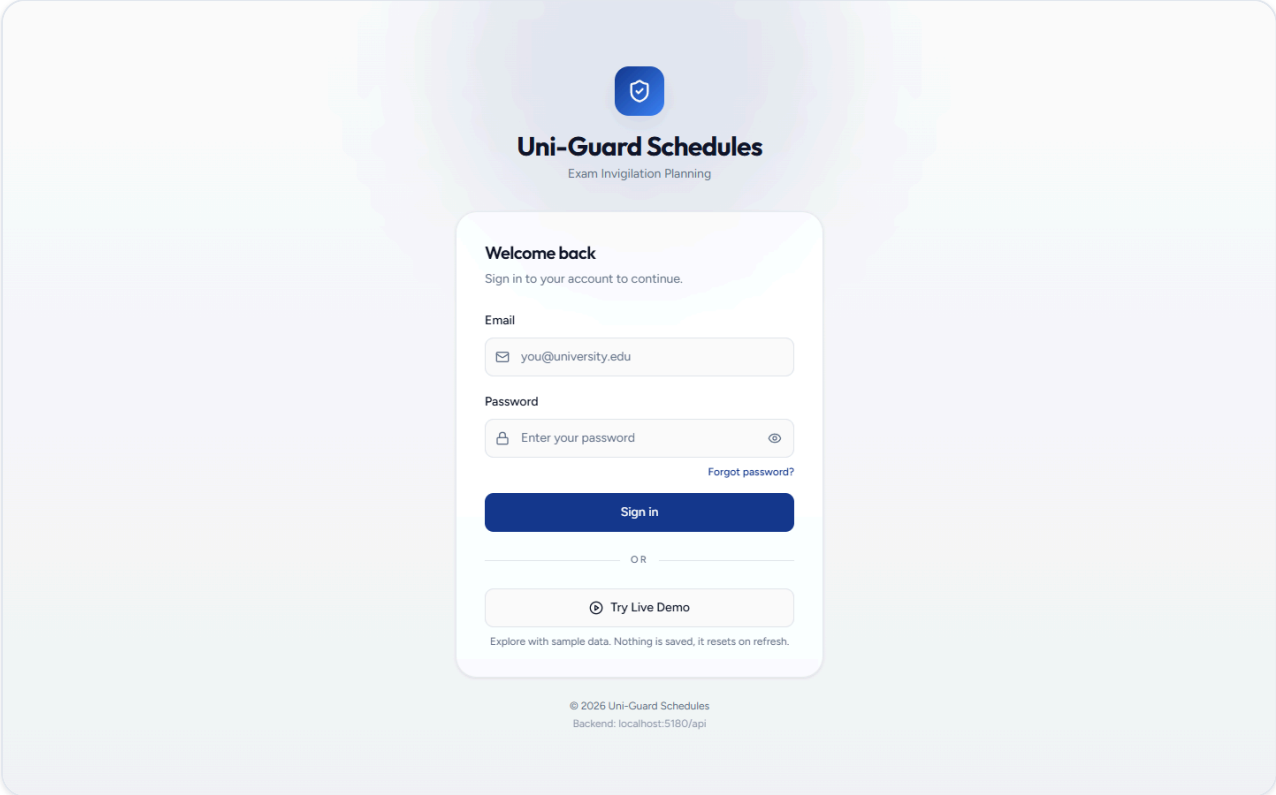
- **Exam period**: one exam season, for example "Fall 2026 Finals". Each period has its own schedule. People, rooms and time slots are shared by every period.
- **Chief invigilator**: the person in charge of a room.
- **Invigilator**: a supervisor in the room.
- **Duty / session**: one sitting at one date and time.

What each role can do

CAN…	ADMIN	SCHEDULER	VIEWER
See dashboard, people, rooms, time slots, timeline, assignments, reports	✓	✓	✓
Export PDF and Excel	✓	✓	✓
Add and edit people, rooms, time slots and assignments	✓	✓	✗
Use Room Allocation, the Scheduler and email schedules	✓	✓	✗
See the Emails page	✓	✓	✗
Change university settings and scheduling rules	✓	✗	✗
Manage users and see the Activity log	✓	✗	✗

Everyone can change their own password and two-step sign-in, and open this guide from **User Guide** in the sidebar.

Open the Uni-Guard link your university gave you and sign in with your email and password.



The sign-in page

- **Email** and **Password**: your account details. The eye button shows or hides the password.
- **Sign in**: opens your dashboard.
- **Forgot password?**: type your email and you get a link to choose a new password.
- **Sign in with Microsoft / Google**: shown when your university switched it on.

Two-step sign-in

If it is on for your account, type the 6-digit code from your authenticator app (for example Google Authenticator) and press **Verify and sign in**. Lost your phone? Press **Lost your phone? Use a recovery code**.

First time? Accept your invitation

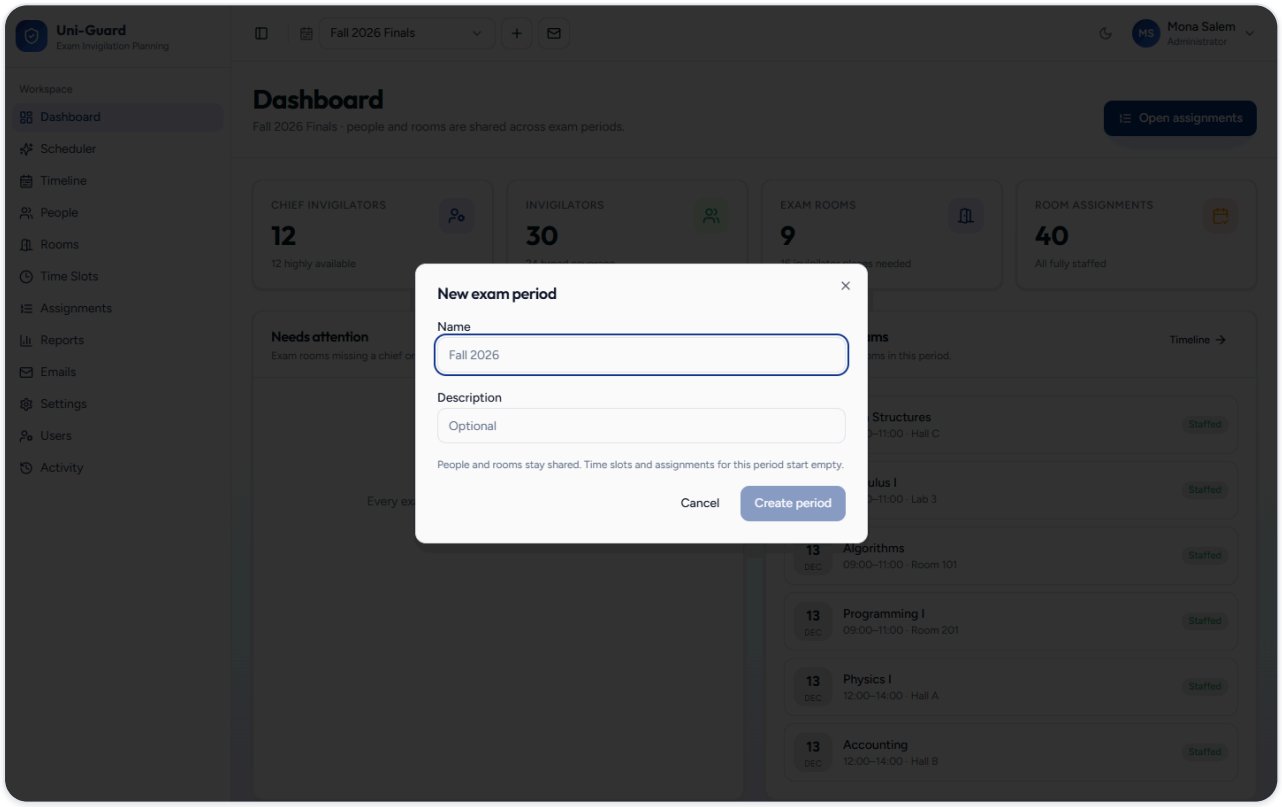
Open the link in the invitation email, choose a password, type it twice and press **Save password**. If the admin gave you a temporary password instead, sign in with it; Uni-Guard then asks you to choose your own.

> After too many wrong passwords the account locks for a short time. Wait, or ask your admin to press **Unlock** on the Users page.

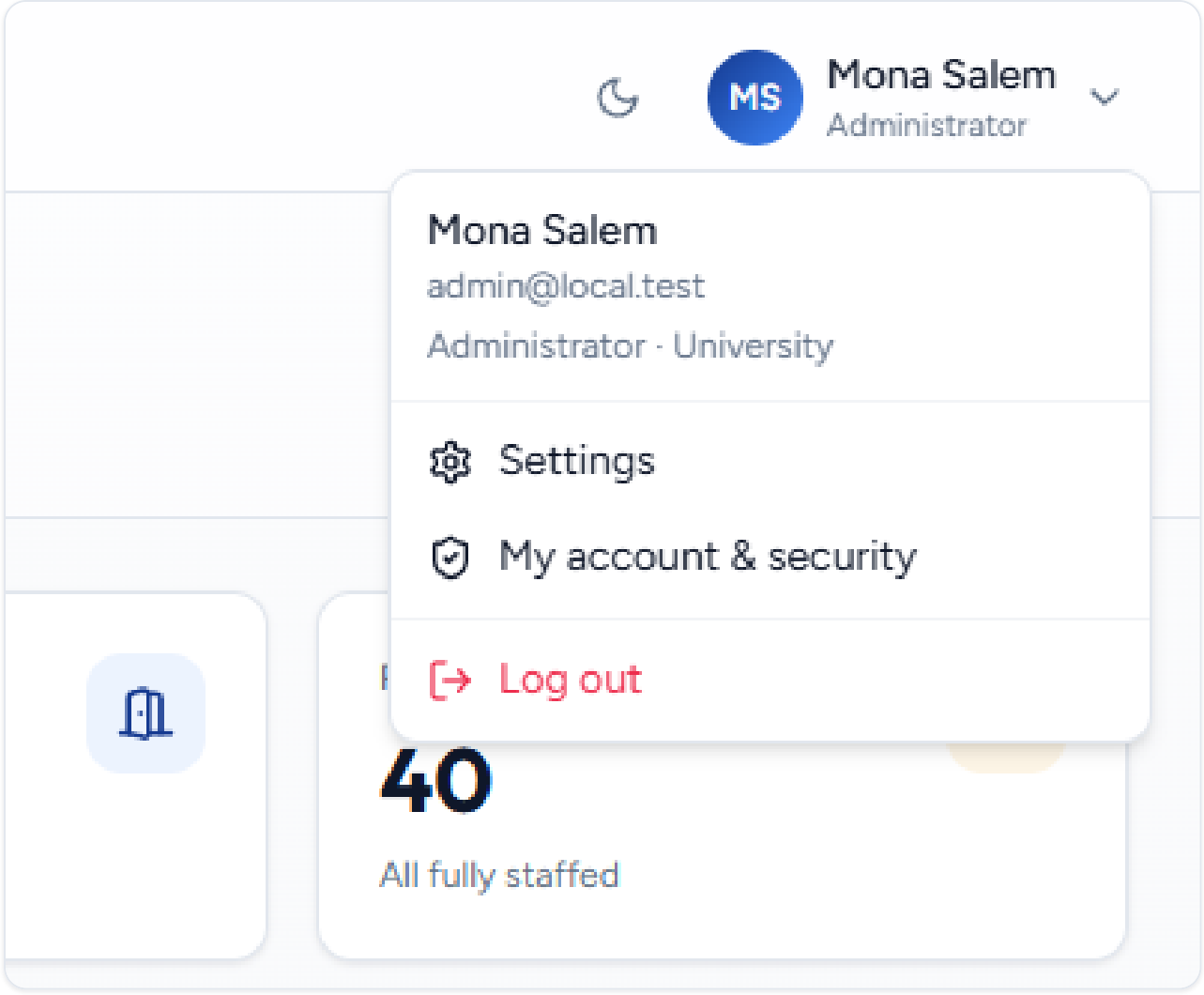
Every page has the same frame: the menu on the left, a bar on top, and the page itself. You only see the pages your role allows.

Top bar, from left to right

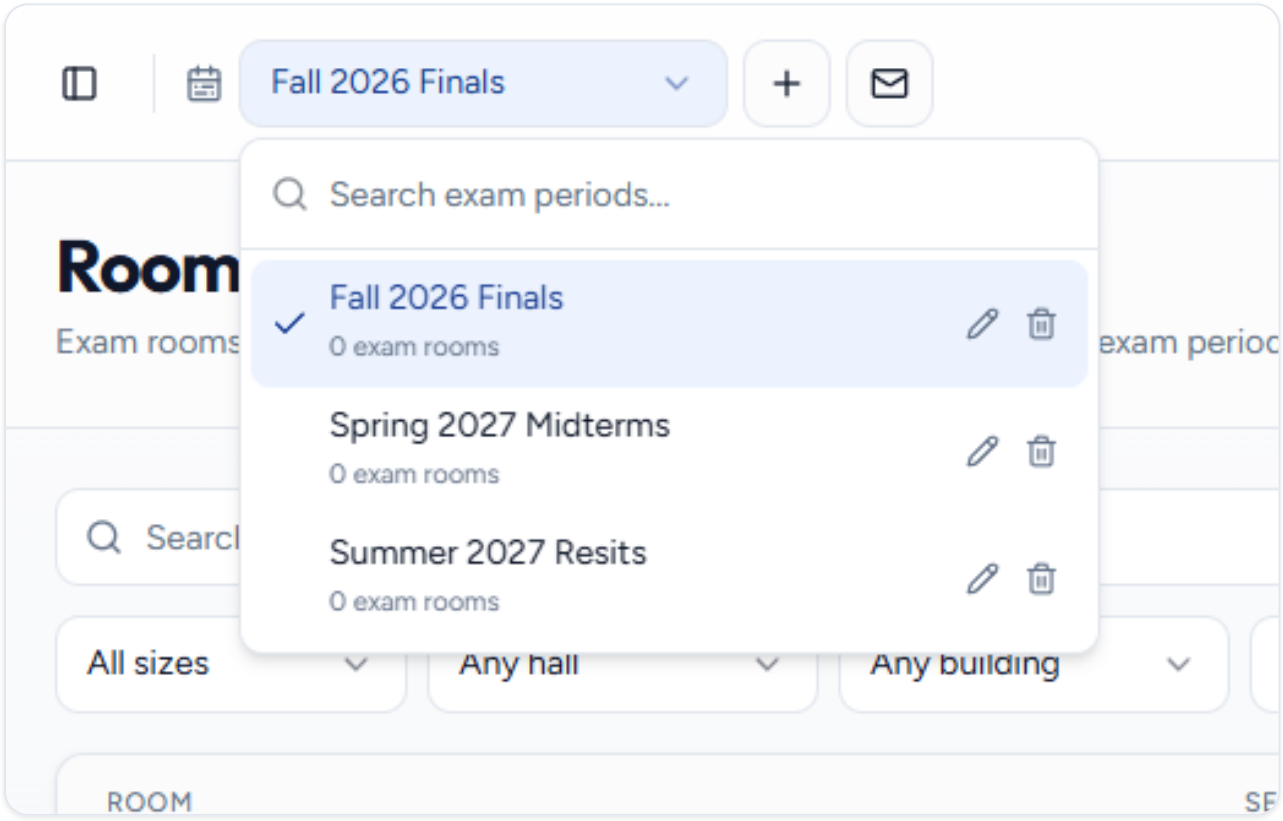
- **Menu button**: folds or opens the sidebar.
- **Exam period selector**: the most important control. Dashboard, Room Allocation, Scheduler, Timeline, Assignments and Reports all show the period chosen here. Type in its search box to find a period; each one shows its number of exam rooms, a **pencil** to rename it and a **bin** to delete it.
- **+ (New exam period)**: type a **Name** (for example "Fall 2026") and an optional **Description**, then **Create period**.
- **Envelope (Email schedules)**: emails every assigned person their own duties for this period. Only new or changed schedules are sent.
- **Moon / sun**: dark or light mode.
- **Your name**: **Settings**, **My account & security**, **Log out**.



New exam period, opened with the + button



The account menu, opened from your name

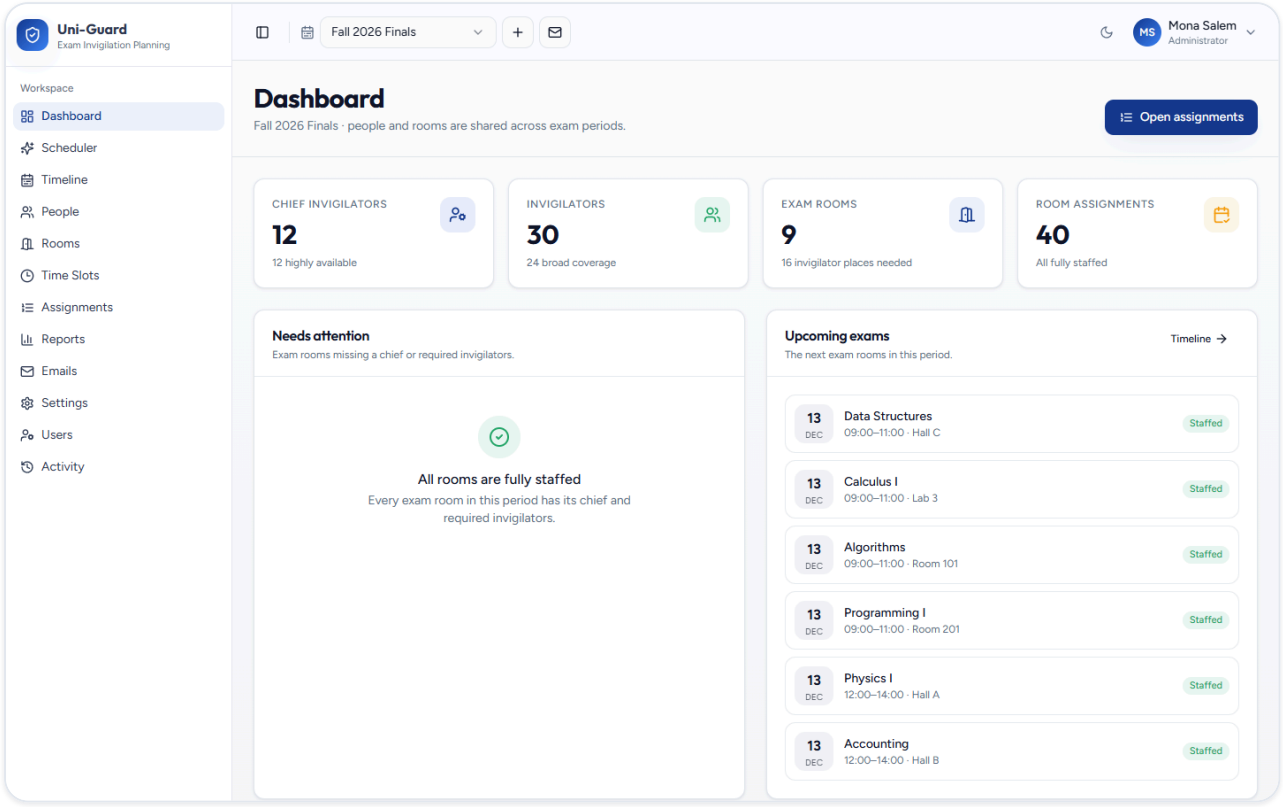


The exam period list: search, rename, delete

Deleting an exam period also deletes its exam rooms, the staff on them and its saved room allocations; people, rooms and time slots stay. A period with exam rooms asks you to type its name first, and the last period cannot be deleted.

On a phone or tablet the sidebar opens from the menu button, the exam period sits on its own row, and tables turn into cards.

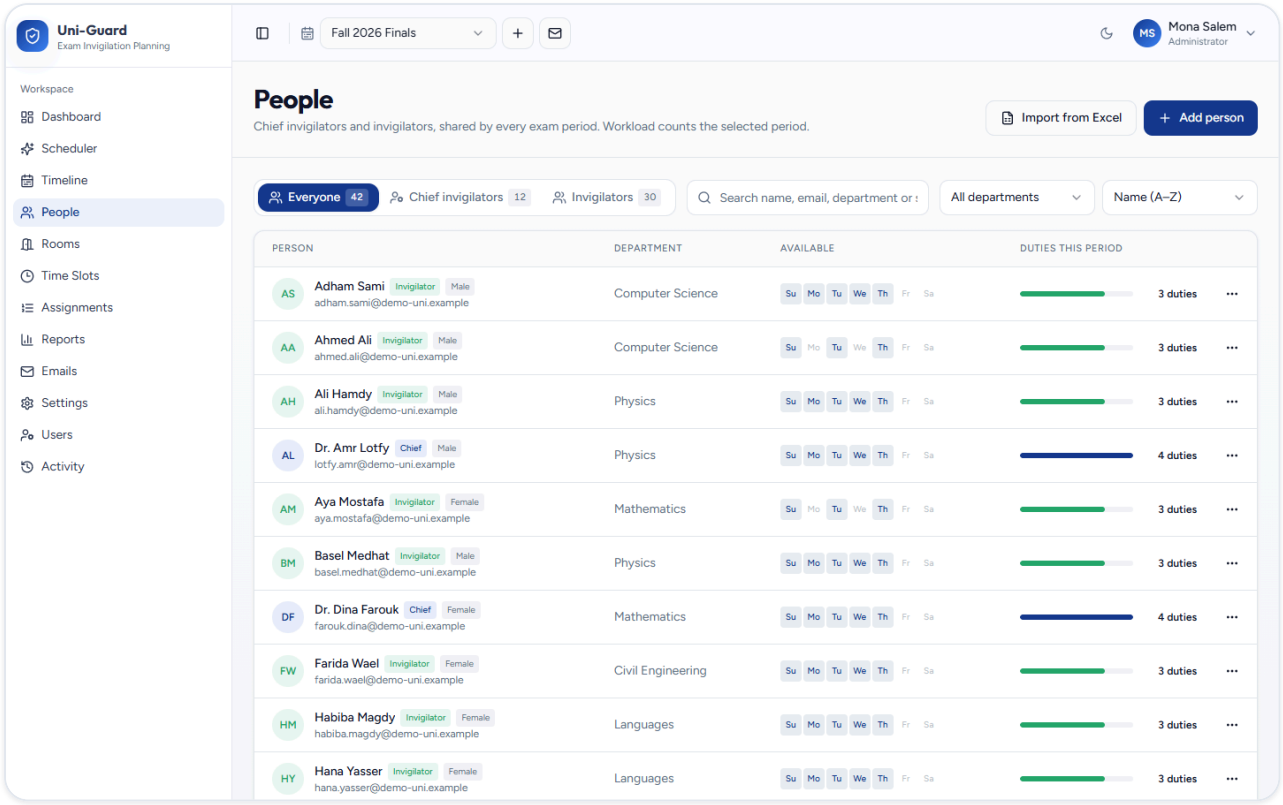
The Dashboard shows the selected exam period at a glance and tells you what to do next.



The Dashboard

- **Get started** (only while something is missing): Add exam rooms, Add people, Set time slots, Create the schedule.
- **Number cards**: chief invigilators, invigilators, exam rooms, room assignments.
- **Needs attention**: rooms missing a chief or invigilators. **Fix in assignments** opens them.
- **Upcoming exams**: the next exam rooms. **Timeline** opens the full list.
- **Open assignments** (top right): jumps to the Assignments list.

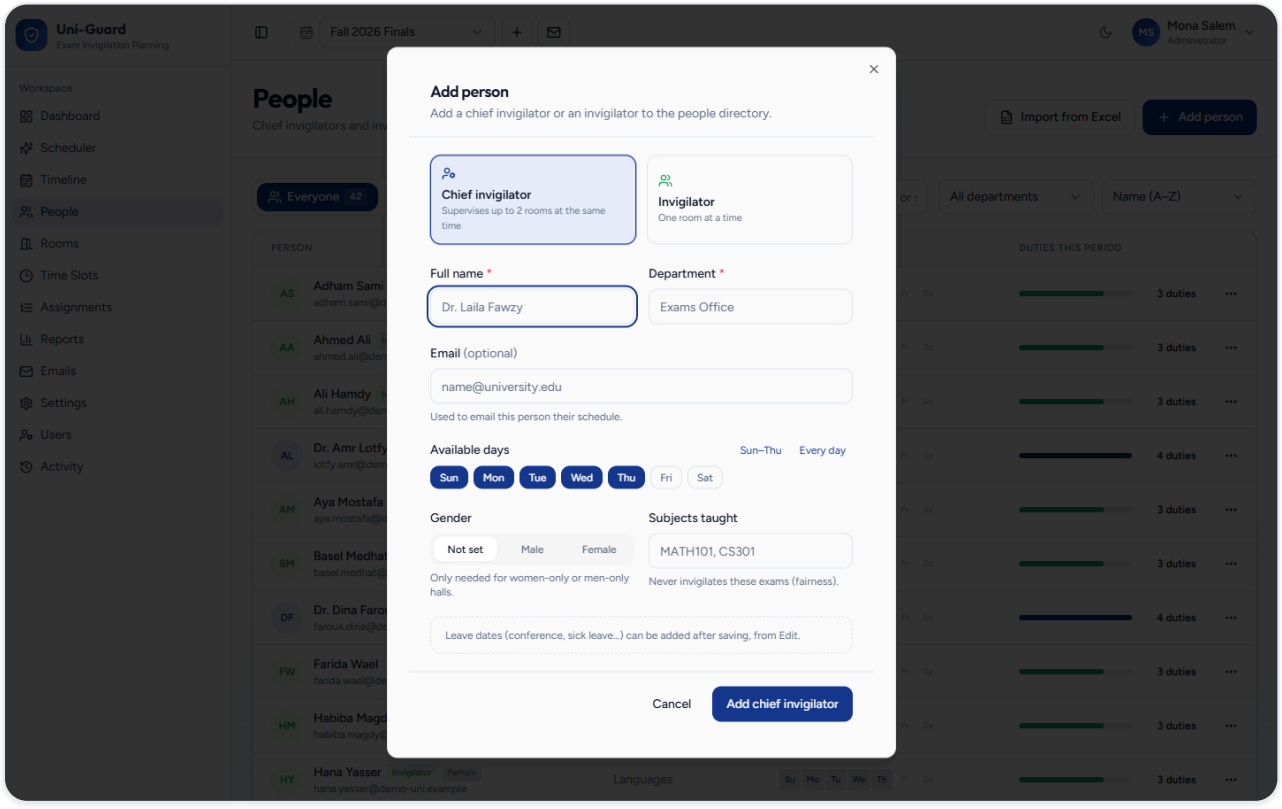
People is the list of everyone who can supervise exams. It is shared by every exam period; **Duties this period** counts the selected period only.



The People page

- **Everyone / Chief invigilators / Invigilators**: show one group.
- **Add person** and **Import from Excel**: add one person or many.
- **Search**, **Department** filter and **Sort** (name, most or fewest duties, department).
- Click a name to see every duty of that person. The row menu has **Edit, leave dates** and **Delete**.

Add or edit a person

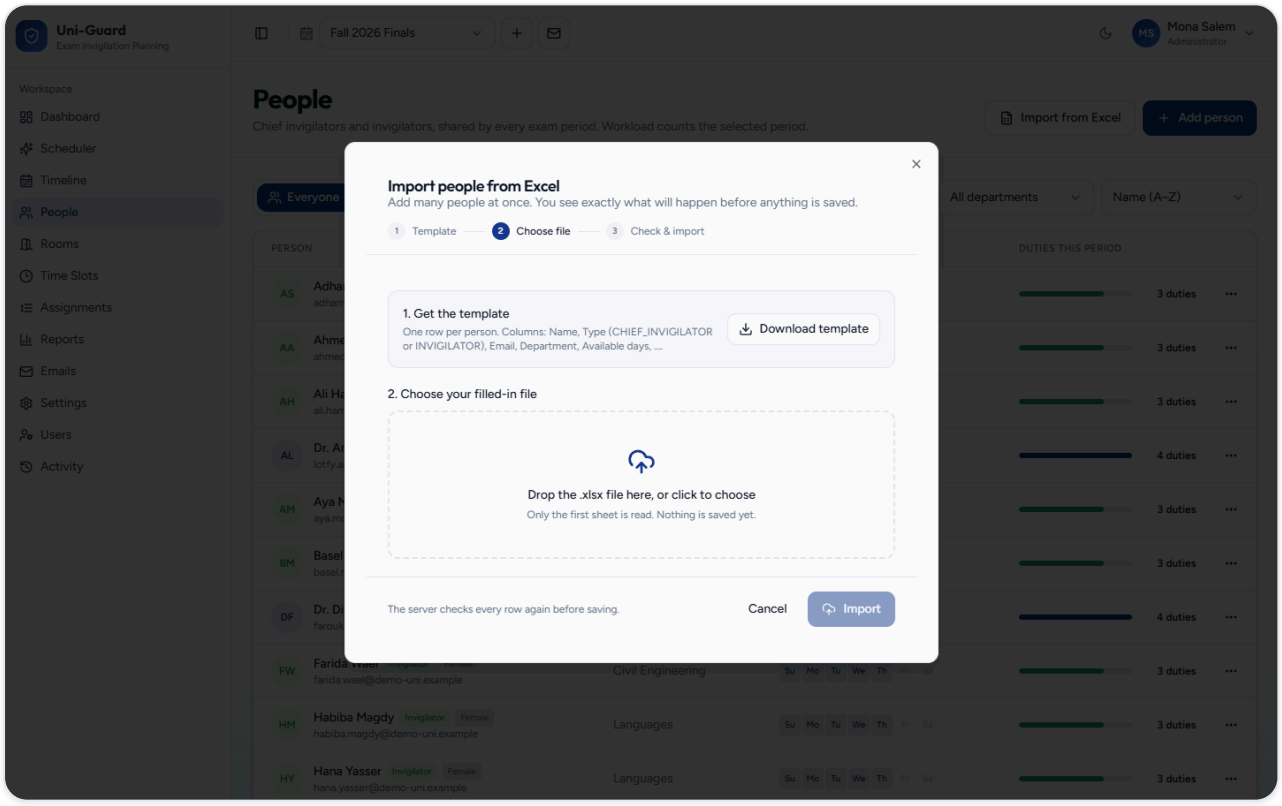


Add person

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Role	Chief invigilator (can cover several rooms at once) or Invigilator (one room)
Full name, Department	Required
Email	Optional. Needed to email them their schedule
Available days	The weekdays they can work. **Sun–Thu** and **Every day** fill it in one click
Gender	Only needed for women-only or men-only halls
Subjects taught	Course codes, for example MATH101. They never supervise these exams

Leave dates: open **Edit**, pick a start and end date, add a reason and press **Add leave**. The Scheduler will not use the person on those days.

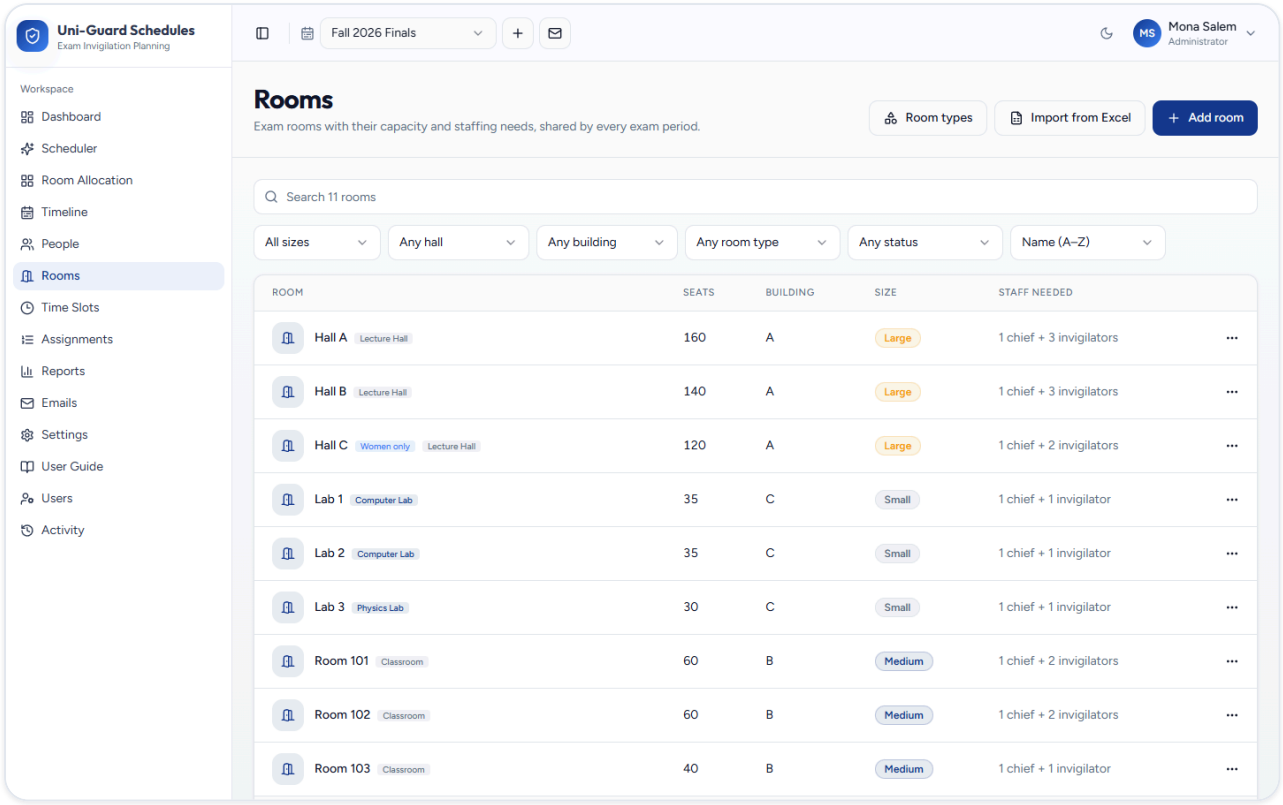
Import from Excel



Import people from Excel

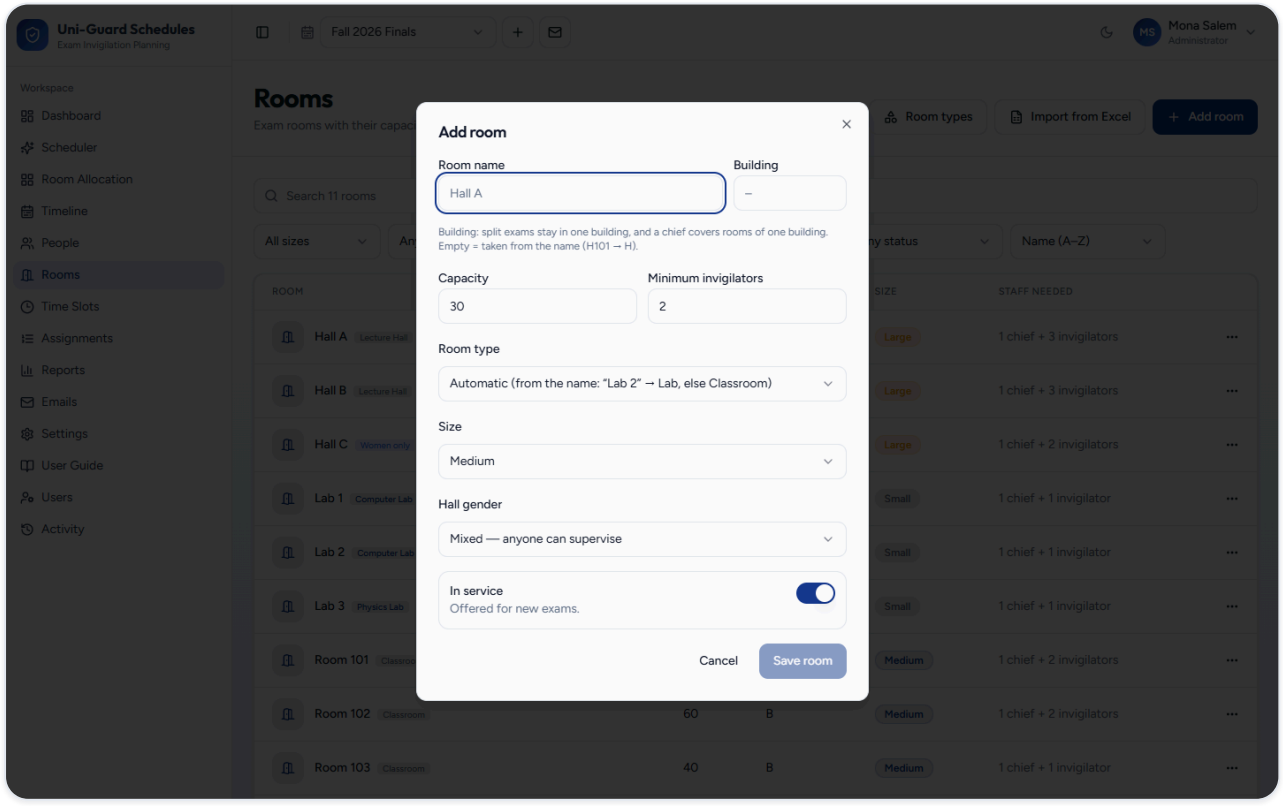
1. Press **Import from Excel**, then **Download template**.
2. Fill one row per person. Only the first sheet is read.
3. Drop the file in the window. Nothing is saved yet: each row shows ready, renamed or a problem.
4. Choose what happens to existing names: **Add with a number** or **Skip it**.
5. Press **Import**. Rows with problems are left out.

Rooms lists every exam hall and lab with its seats and staffing needs. Rooms are shared by every exam period.



The Rooms page

- **Add room**, **Import from Excel** (same steps as people), **Room types**, **Search**, filters (size, hall, type, building) and **Sort**.
- Each row: seats, type, building, size and staff needed, with **Edit** and **Delete**.
- **Out of service**: switch a room off for a while (repairs, events). Room Allocation and the Scheduler then skip it; its old exams stay.



Add room

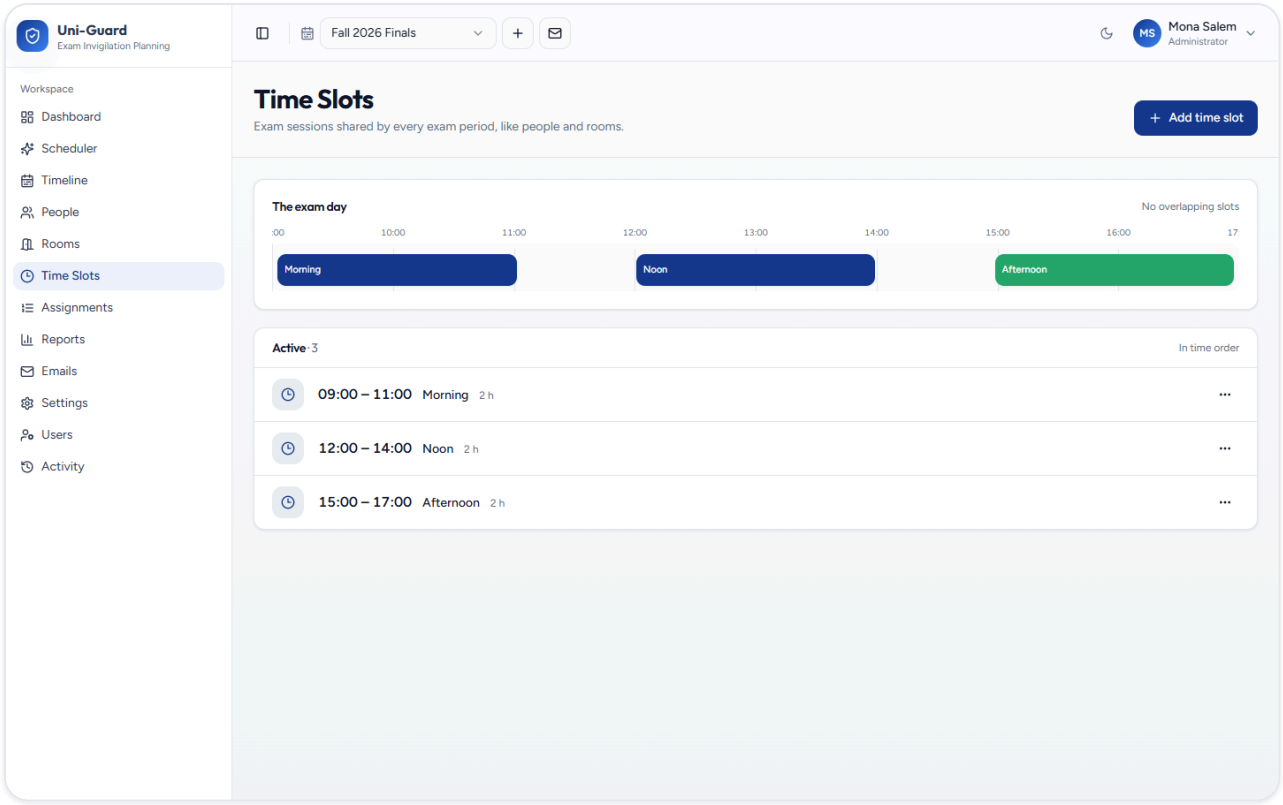
FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Room name	For example "Hall A"
Capacity	Number of seats
Minimum invigilators	Invigilators the room always needs, besides the chief
Size	Small, Medium or Large
Room type	Classroom, or a special type such as Computer Lab or Drawing Studio
Building	For example "B". Room Allocation keeps one exam in one building when it can
Hall gender	Mixed (anyone), Male hall or Female hall

Room types

Press **Room types** to edit your university's list. A **special** type (labs, studios) is only given to exams that ask for exactly that type in the exam list; normal exams never use it. Room Allocation never puts an exam in another type when its type runs out: it shows the problem instead.

> In the rooms Excel import, column 6 is **Room Type** and column 7 is **Building**. Leave them empty and Uni-Guard guesses from the room name (for example "Lab 3" is a lab, "B204" is in building B).

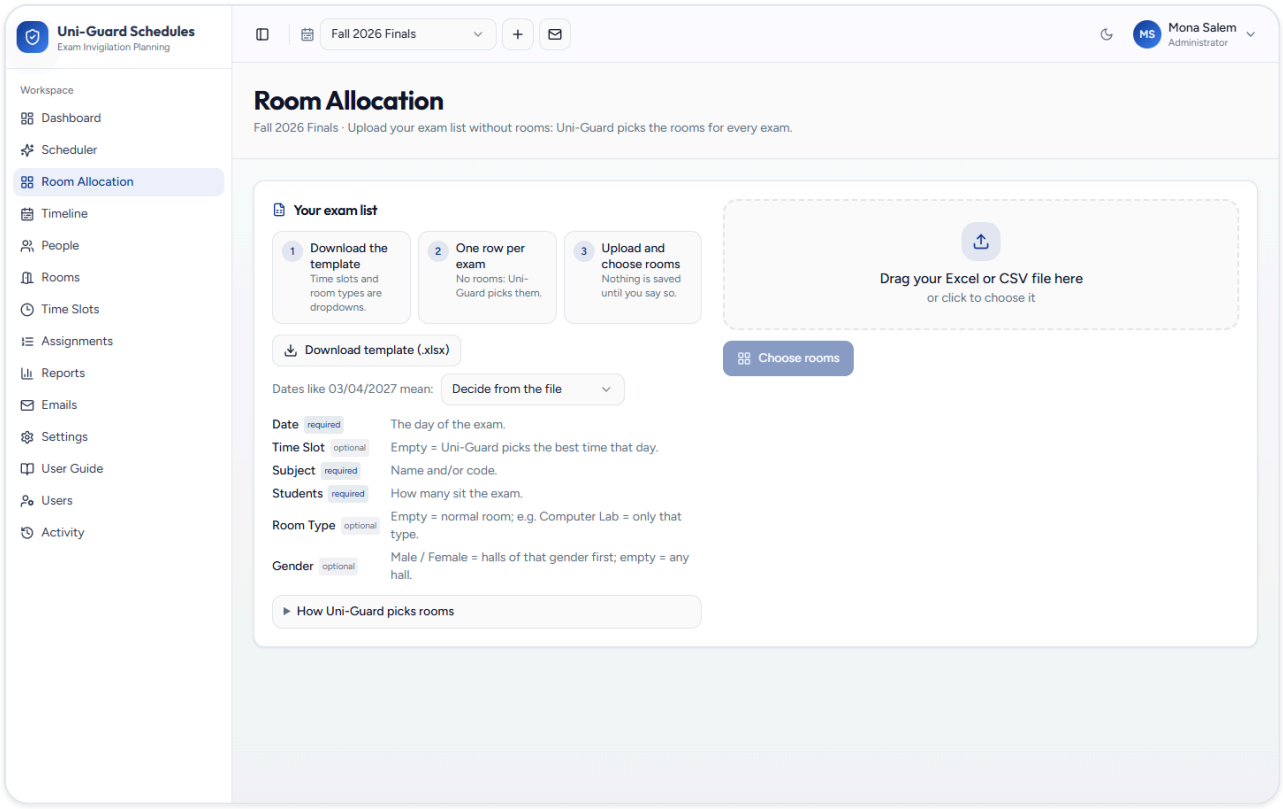
Time slots are the exam sittings of a day, for example Morning 09:00–11:00. They are shared by every exam period, and several exams can run in the same slot in different rooms.



The Time Slots page

- **Add time slot**: optional name, start and end.
- **The exam day**: a picture of the day, so gaps and overlaps are easy to see.
- **Edit**, **Deactivate** (stop offering it, old exams stay), **Activate**, **Delete** (refused while an exam uses it).

Room Allocation is for when you know your exams but not their rooms. Upload an exam list without rooms: Uni-Guard picks the rooms for every exam (and the time, when you leave it empty). Then **Create schedule** adds the chiefs and invigilators.



Room Allocation: the steps, the columns and the upload area

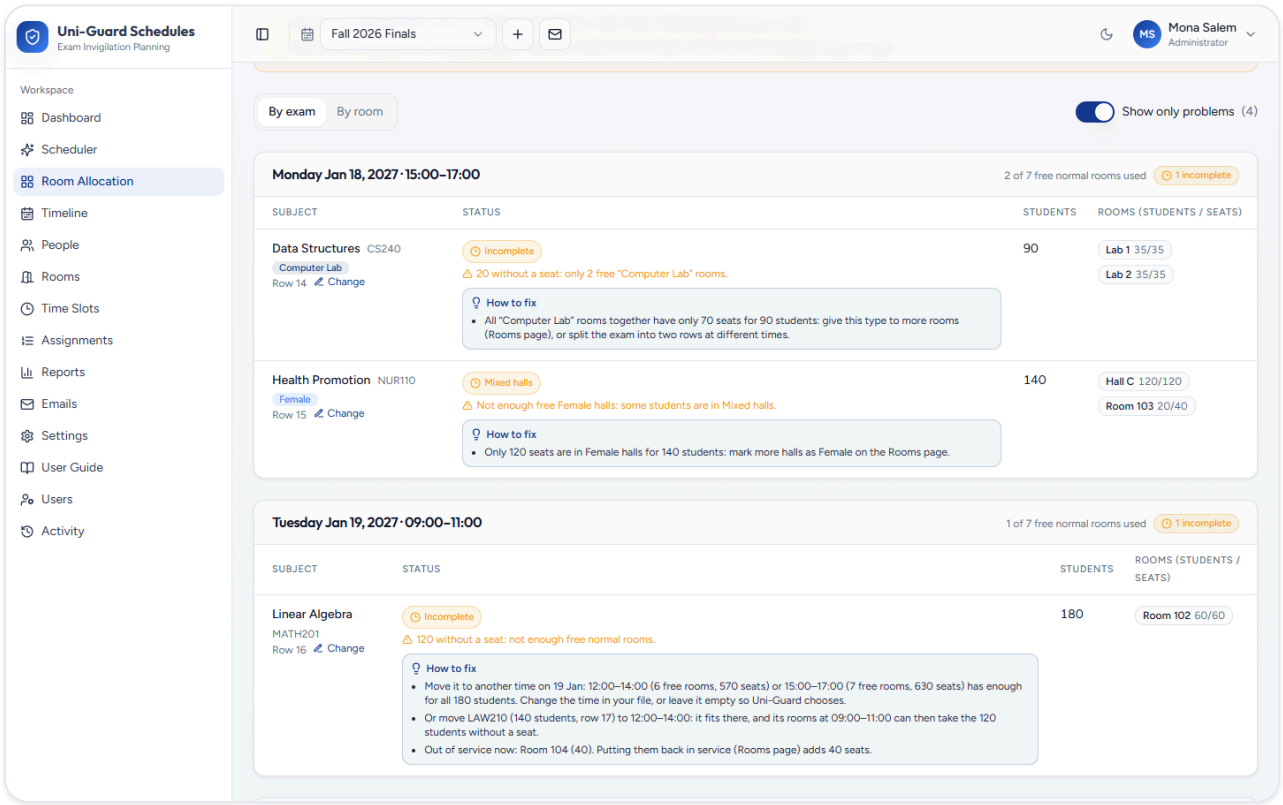
1. Check the exam period in the top bar.
2. Press **Download template (.xlsx)**. Its time slot and room type columns are dropdowns, and the day fills in by itself.
3. Fill one row per exam (see the columns below) and drag the file onto the upload area.
4. Press **Choose rooms**. Nothing is saved yet: you see the plan first.
5. Check the plan, change what you like, then press **Save rooms**.
6. Press **Create schedule** to add chiefs and invigilators, then **Open in Scheduler** to check them.

COLUMN	WHAT TO ENTER
Date	Required. If dates like 03/04/2027 are read the wrong way, change **Dates like 03/04/2027 mean**
Time Slot	Optional. Empty = Uni-Guard picks the best time that day (enough free rooms and staff, spread over the day)
Subject Name / Subject Code	At least one of them
Number of Students	Required
Room Type	Optional. Empty = a normal room; for example Computer Lab = only rooms of exactly that type
Gender	Optional. Male / Female = halls of that gender first, then Mixed halls (shown in yellow). Men and women of one subject at the same time: two rows

How rooms are picked

- A room holds one subject at a time; a big subject is split over several rooms, in one building when it can.
- Fewest rooms first, then the fewest empty seats. Rooms are filled to the last seat.
- Never used: rooms out of service, rooms of another type, and rooms already booked at that time (also by other exam periods).

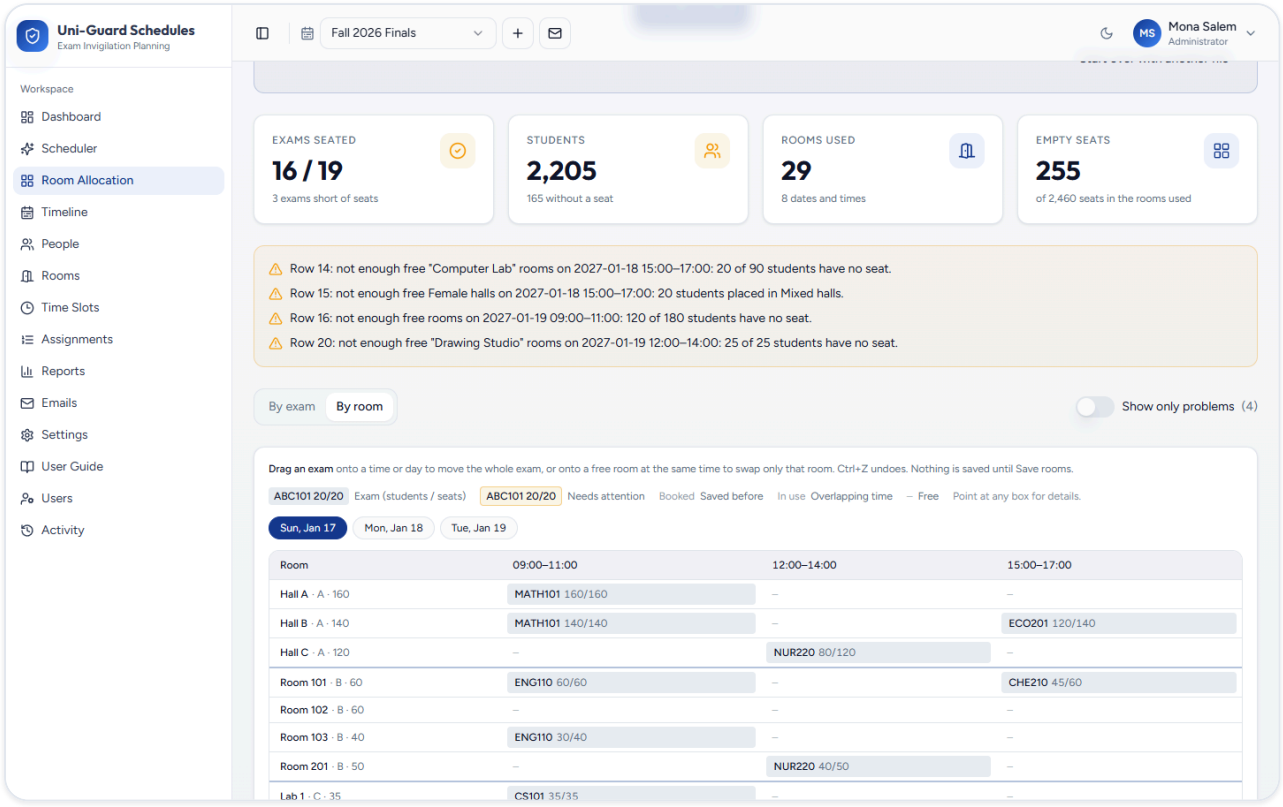
Reading the plan



The plan, by exam: rooms, problems and how to fix them

- **Number cards**: exams, students, rooms used, empty seats and students without a seat.

- **By exam**: one row per exam with its rooms. Badges: **Time chosen** (the file had no time), **Changed by you**, the room type and the gender.
- **Problems** (students without a seat, Male/Female exams in Mixed halls) come with **hints**: another time that day, a smaller exam to move, rooms out of service you could switch on.
- **Show only problems** hides everything that is fine.



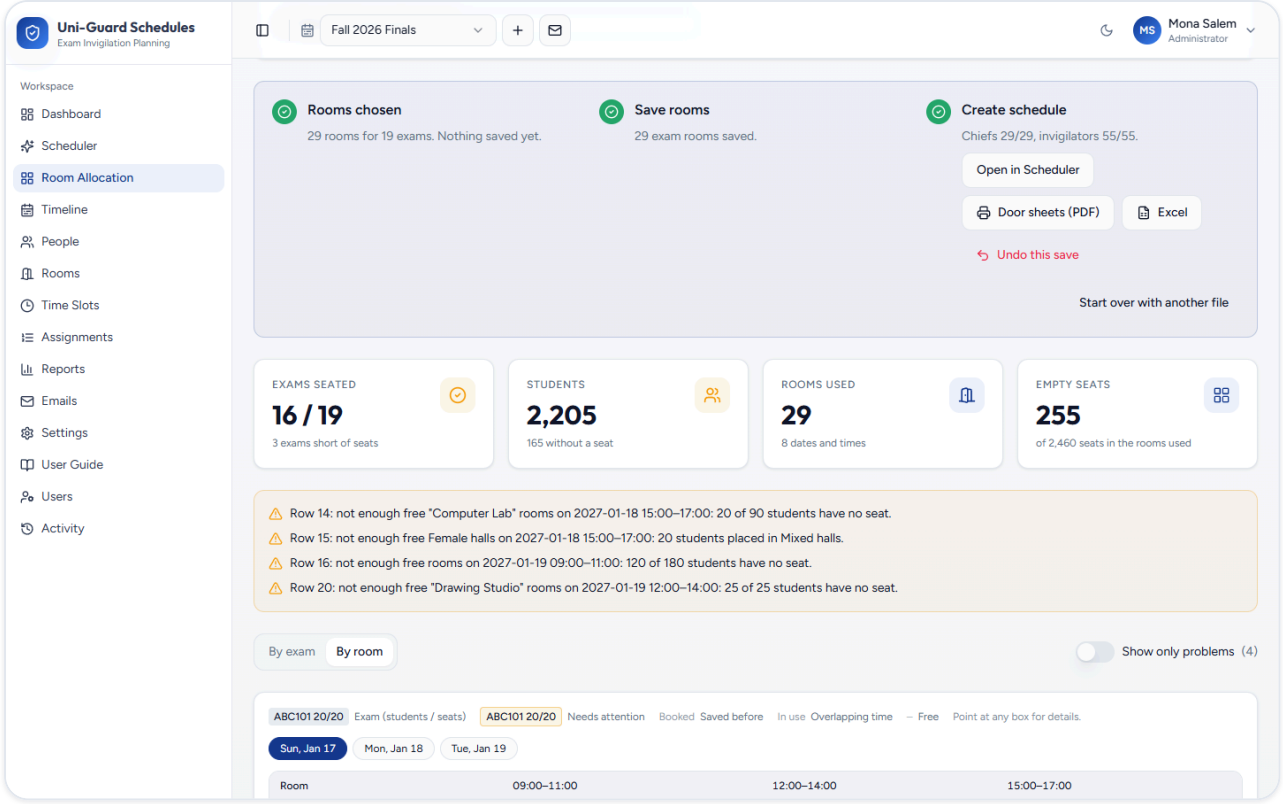
The plan, by room: every room and time slot of one day

IN THE ROOM VIEW	MEANING
Blue box (ABC101 20/20)	An exam of this plan in that room: students / seats
Yellow box	The exam as a whole needs attention. Point at it to see why
Booked	Taken by an exam already saved in Uni-Guard
In use	Taken by an exam of this plan at an overlapping time
–	Free

Changing the plan before saving

- **Change** (under an exam): pick another date, time or rooms.
- **Drag and drop** in the room view: drop an exam on a time or a day to move the whole exam, or on a free room at the same time to swap only that room. Only places where it fits light up, and a box at the bottom says why while you drag. A move that would leave more students without a seat is refused.
- **Undo last move** (or Ctrl+Z) and **Undo my changes**. Your plan and changes are kept if you refresh the page; **Start over** clears them.

After saving

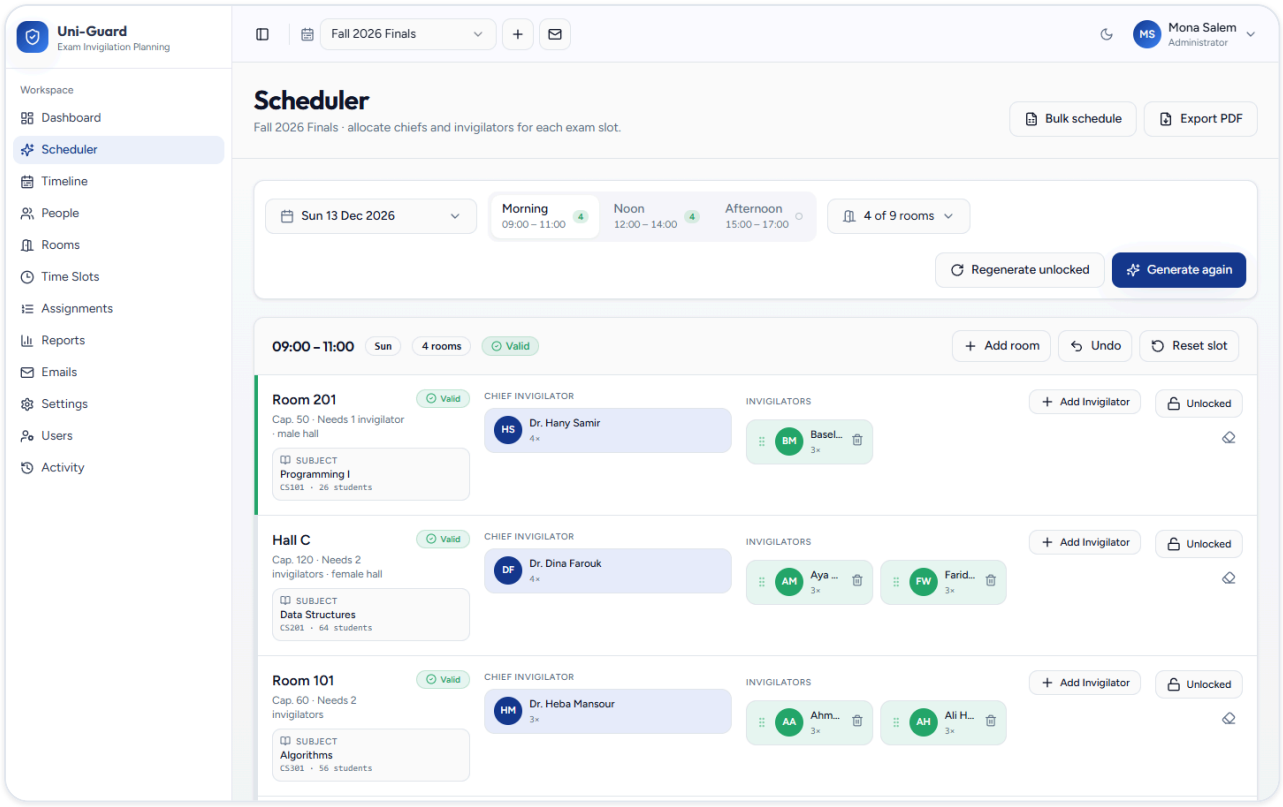


After Save rooms: Create schedule, open in the Scheduler, print

- **Create schedule**: adds chiefs and invigilators to the saved rooms, with the same rules as the Scheduler (nearby rooms share a chief).
- **Door sheets (PDF)**: one page per room and time to put on the door. **Excel**: one row per exam room.
- **Saved allocations**: every save of this period. **Undo** removes that save's exam rooms again.

> Exams that need a lab only get labs of exactly that type. If labs run out, the exam shows the problem instead of using a normal room: add a lab, switch one back on, or move the exam to another time.

The Scheduler fills one **date + time slot** at a time with fair, clash-free staff.



The Scheduler: date, time slot, rooms, and one card per exam room

Build one slot

1. Check the exam period in the top bar.
2. Pick the **date**, then the **time slot** (Morning, Noon…).
3. Open the rooms button (for example **4 of 9 rooms**) and tick the rooms that have an exam.
4. Press **Generate schedule**. Each room gets a chief and its invigilators.
5. Adjust what you like, then press **Save** (Ctrl+S). Nothing is stored before you save.

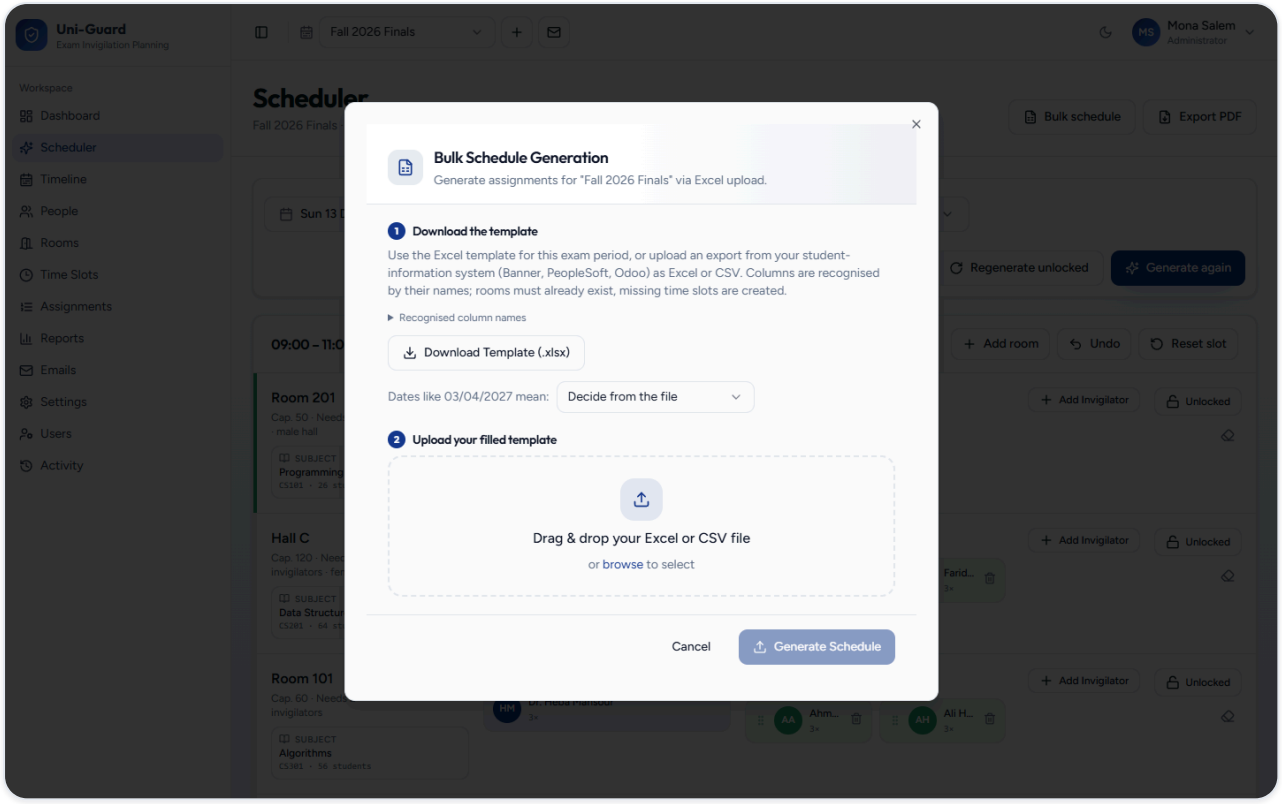
Each room card

- Click a person to change them. The list only shows people who are free (also in other exam periods), available, not on leave, allowed in that hall and not teaching that subject. The last line says how many were hidden.
- Drag the dots beside an invigilator onto another to swap them. The bin removes an extra position.
- **Add Invigilator** adds a position. **Unlocked / Locked**: locked rooms stay as they are when you generate again. The eraser empties the room.
- Badges: **Valid**, **Shared** (one chief for several rooms), **Incomplete**, **Conflict**. The number after a name (3×) is that person's duties this period.

Other buttons

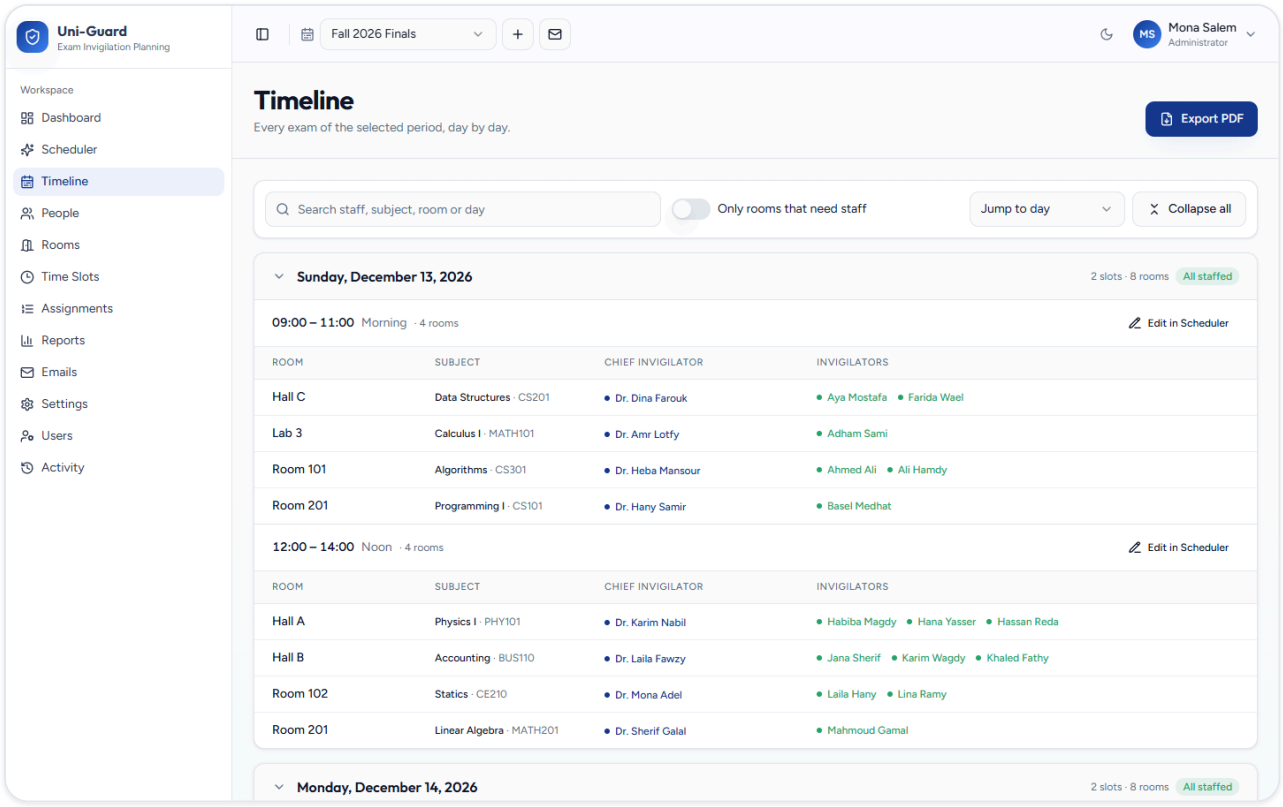
- **Add room**, **Undo**, **Reset slot** (back to the last generated version), **Regenerate unlocked**.
- **Bulk schedule**: upload a whole timetable (Excel or CSV, also Banner, PeopleSoft and Odoo exports) and generate every slot at once.

- **Export PDF**: see Timeline & export.



Bulk schedule

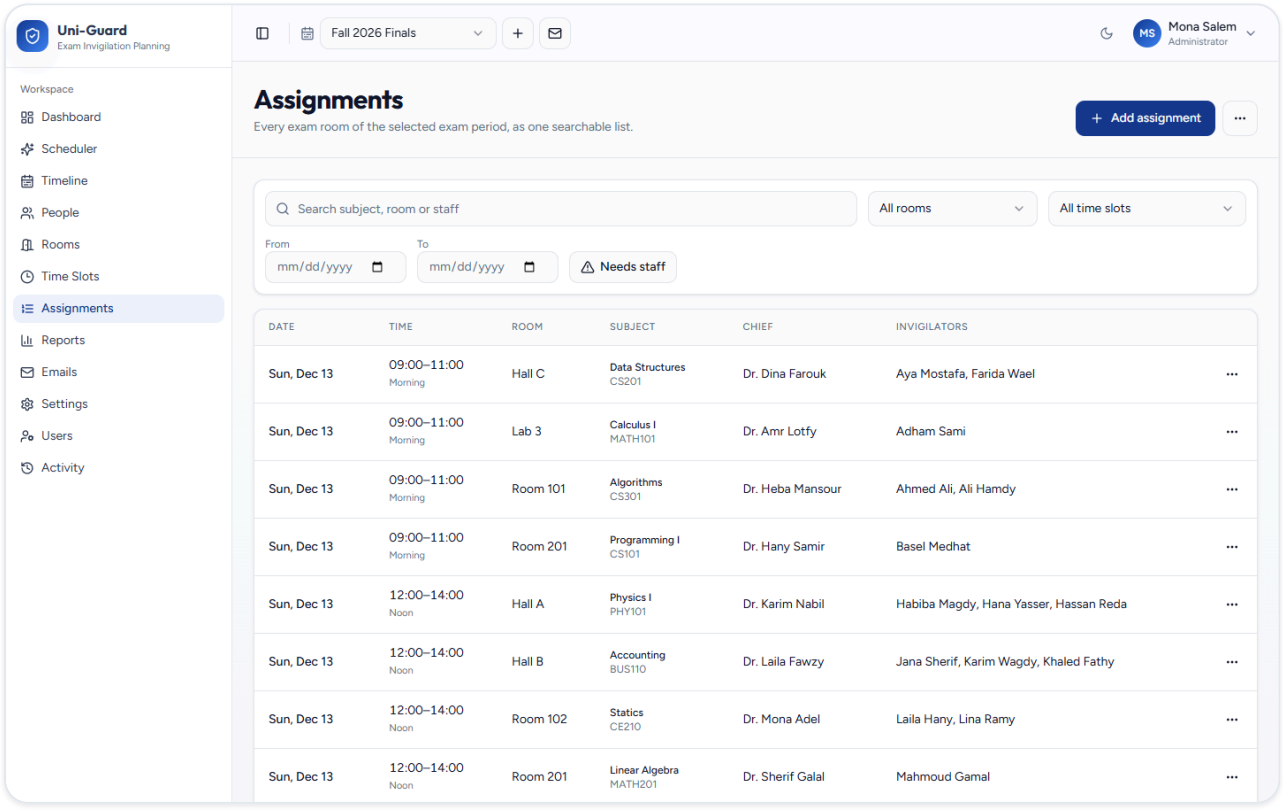
Timeline shows every exam of the period, day by day. It is the easiest page for checking and sharing.



The Timeline

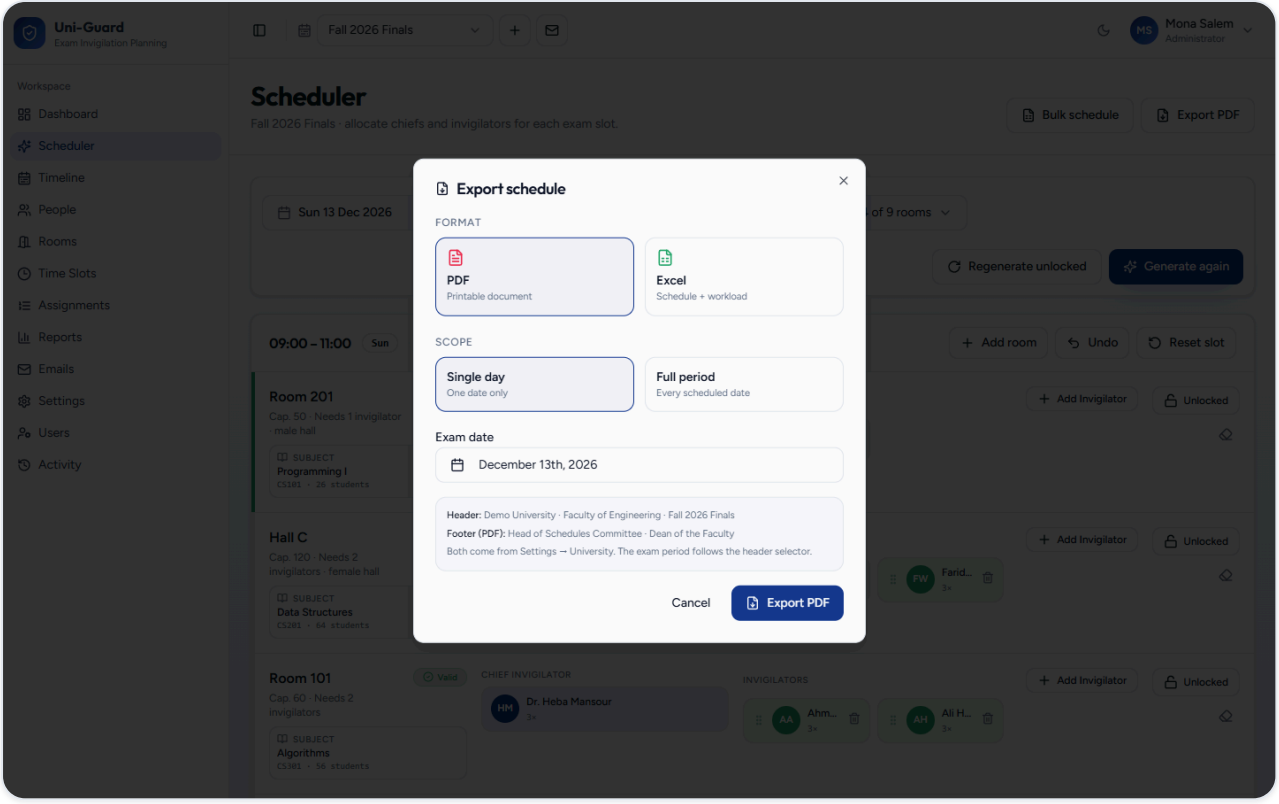
- **Search** staff, subject, room or day. **Only rooms that need staff** shows the gaps.
- **Jump to day**, **Expand all**, **Collapse all**, **Edit in Scheduler**.

Assignments is the same data as one list, for fixing single rooms: filters, **Add assignment** by hand, **Edit** and **Delete** per row, and **Delete all** of a period (you type its name to confirm).



The Assignments list

Export



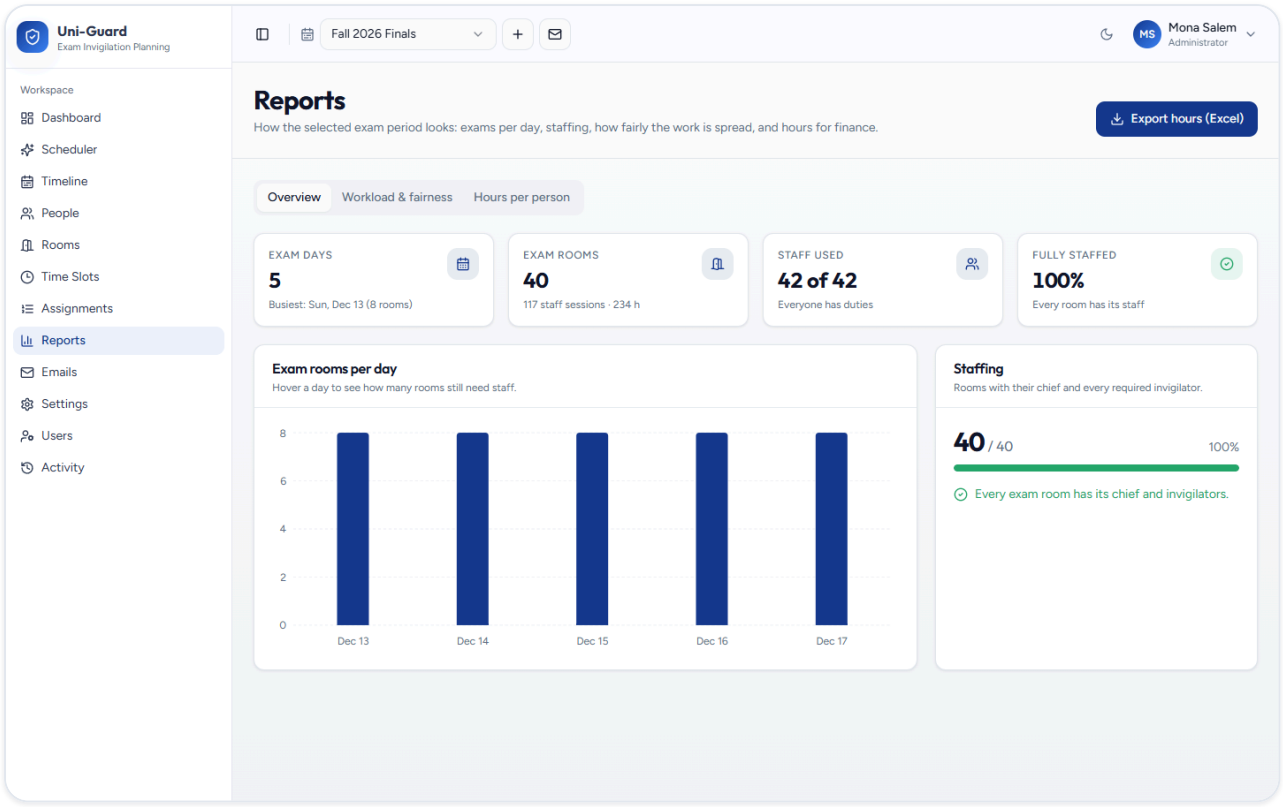
Export

CHOICE	OPTIONS
Format	PDF (printable) or Excel (schedule + workload)
Scope	Single day or Full period

The PDF header and signatures come from **Settings → University**.

Reports shows how the selected exam period looks, in three tabs.

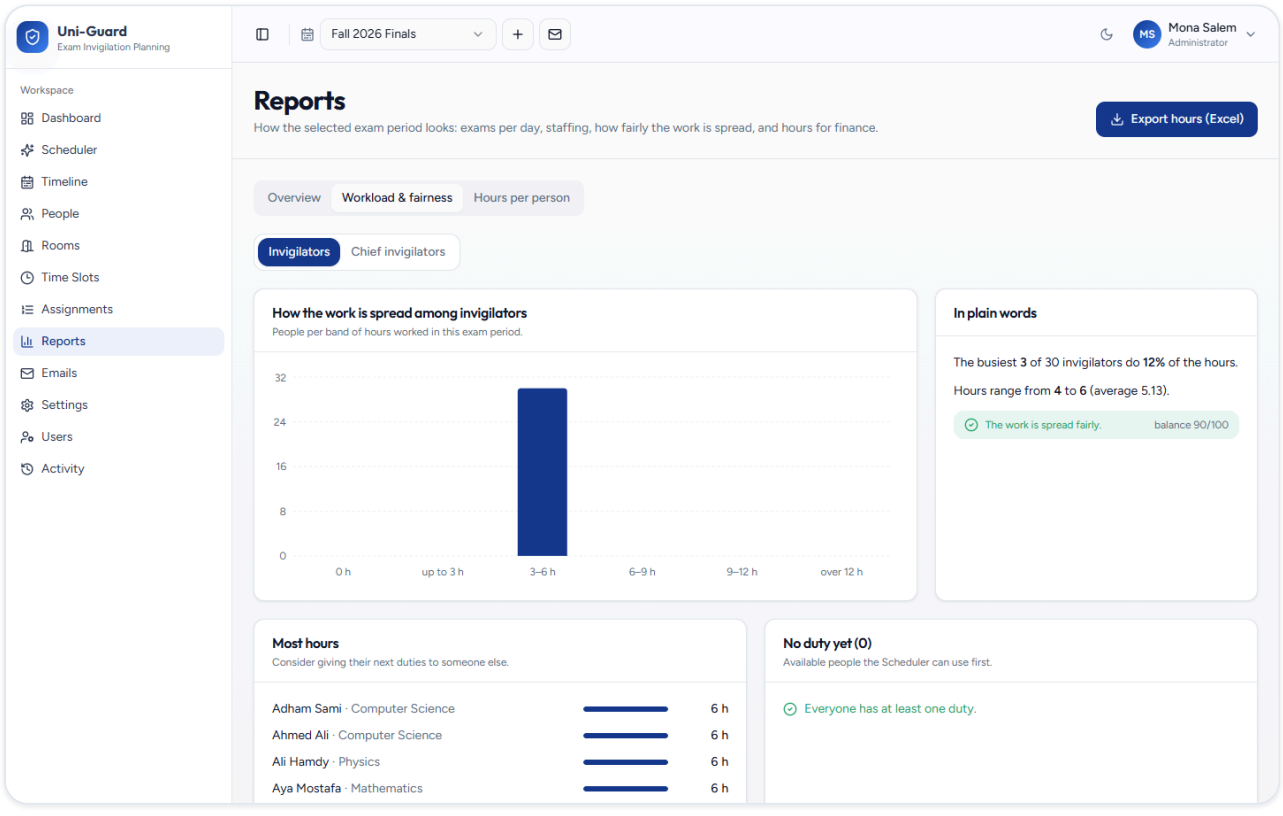
Overview



Reports: Overview

Exam days, exam rooms, staff used and how many rooms are fully staffed, with exam rooms per day.

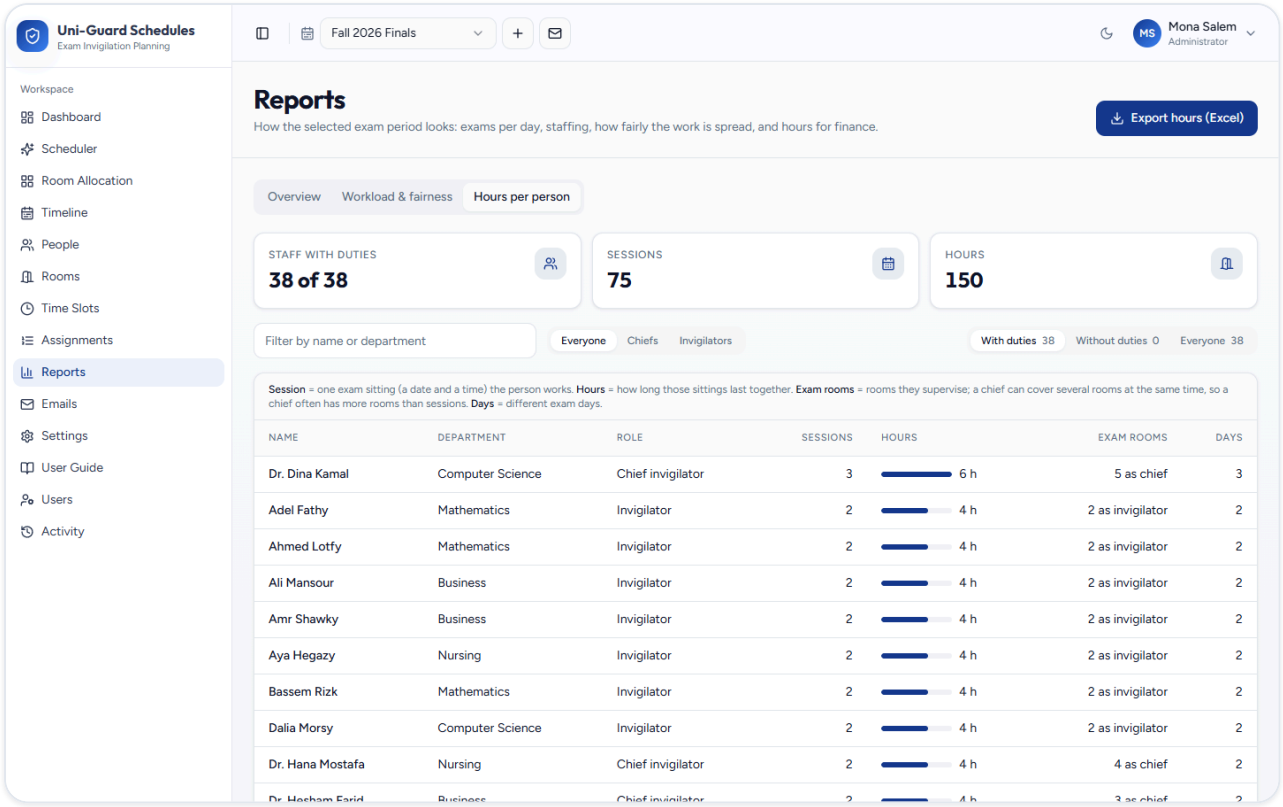
Workload & fairness



Reports: Workload & fairness

How evenly hours are spread, who has the most hours, who has none yet, and hours per department.

Hours per person

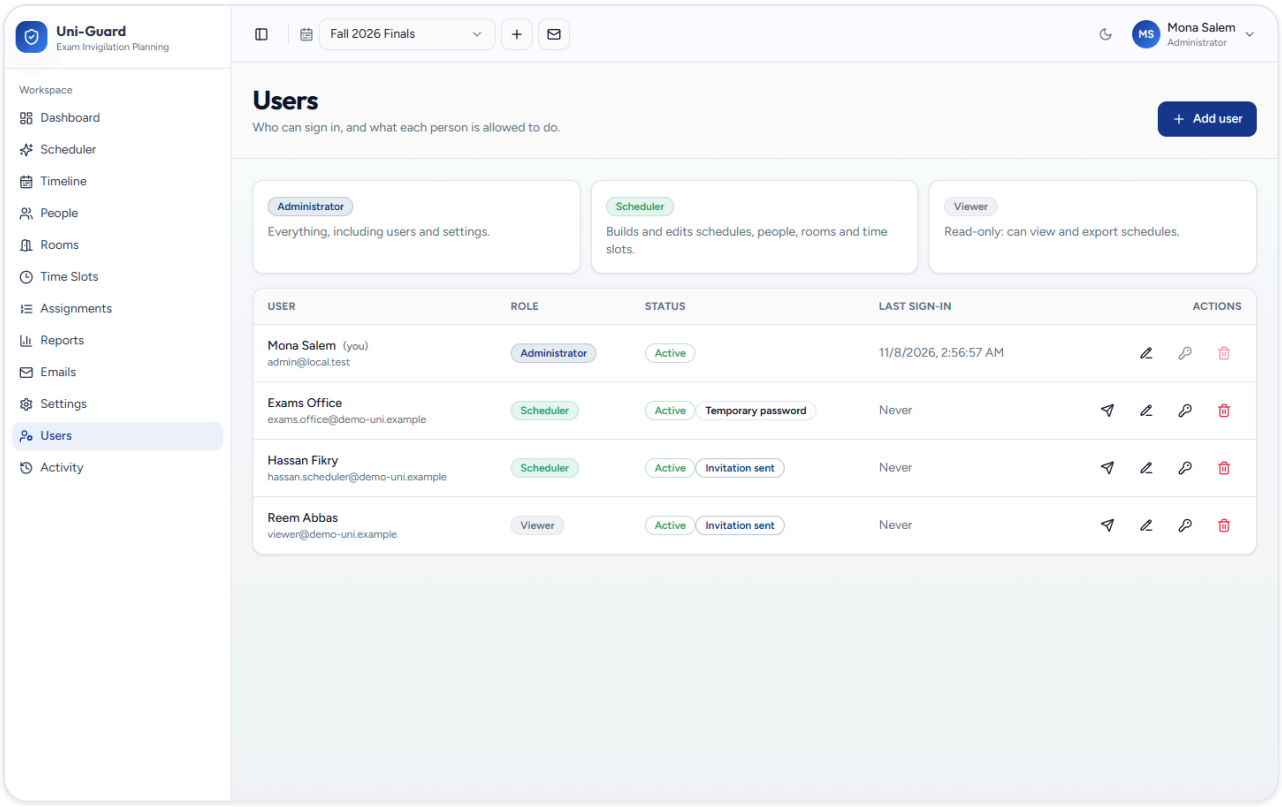


Reports: Hours per person

Sessions, rooms, days and hours for each person. **Export hours (Excel)** downloads it for finance.

> A session is one sitting. A chief covering two rooms at the same time works one session.

Users lists who can sign in. This is separate from People: a person in People does not need an account.

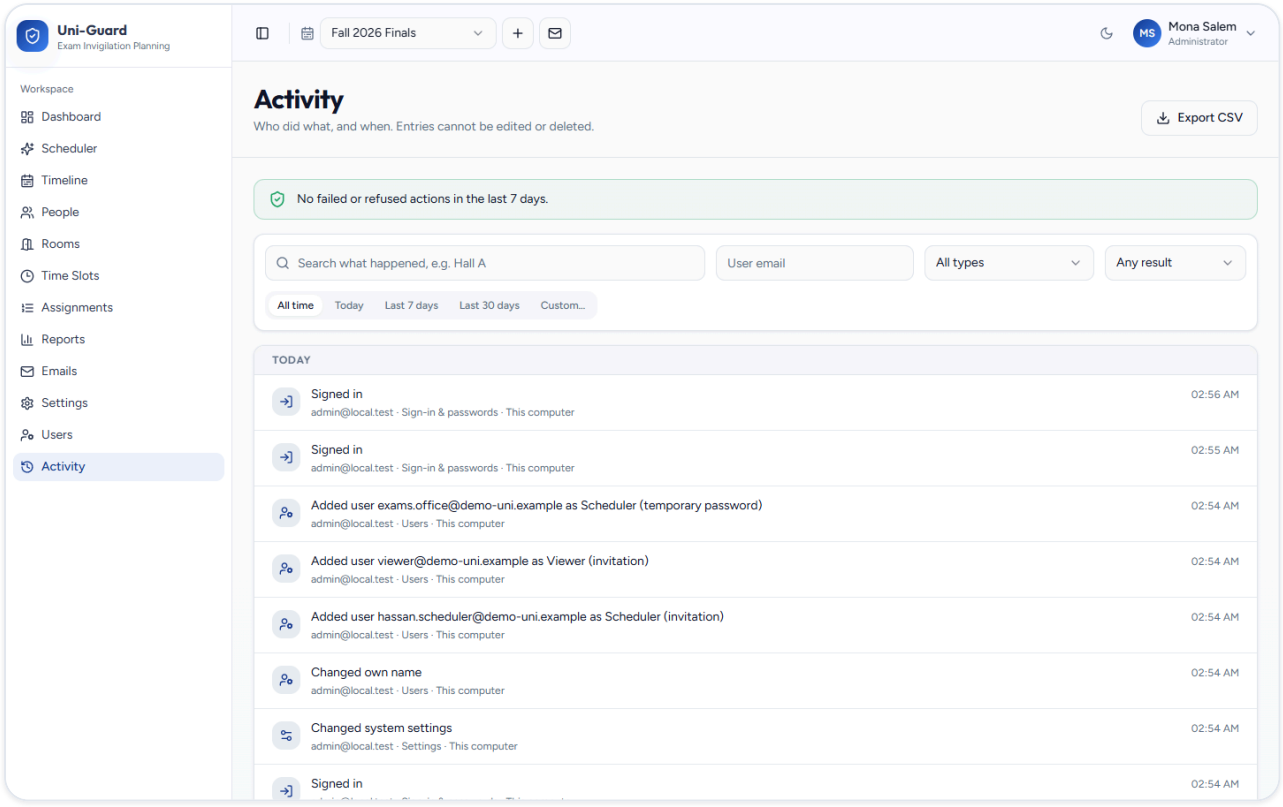


The Users page

1. Press **Add user**, type the email and an optional name, and pick **Admin**, **Scheduler** or **Viewer**.
2. Choose **Send an invitation email** (recommended) or a temporary password you give them yourself.
3. Press **Add and invite**. You can also copy the invitation link.

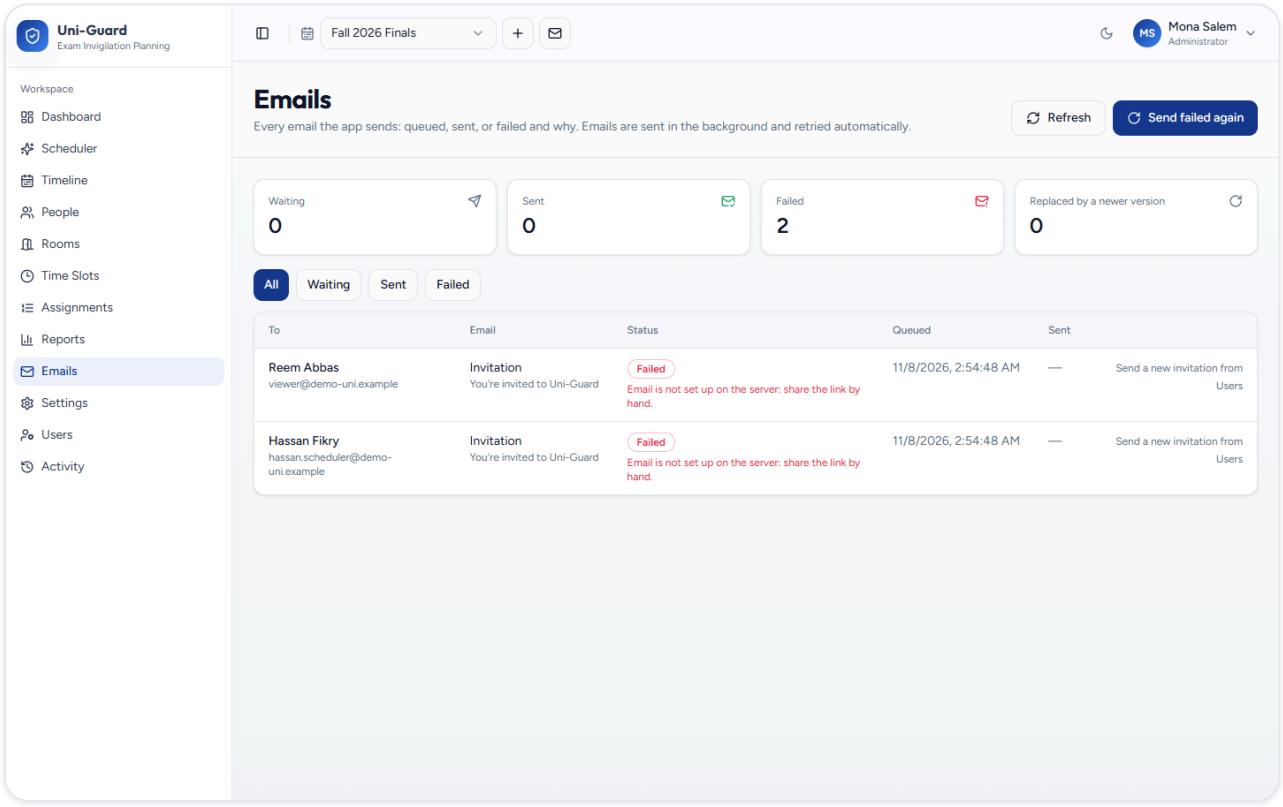
ICON	WHAT IT DOES
Paper plane	Sends a new invitation link
Open lock	Unlocks a locked account
Shield	Removes two-step sign-in (lost phone)
Pencil	Change name or role, or disable the account
Key	Sets a new temporary password and signs them out everywhere
Bin	Deletes the user

Activity (admins) records sign-ins and every change. Entries cannot be edited or deleted. Filter by text, user, type, result and date, and **Export CSV**.



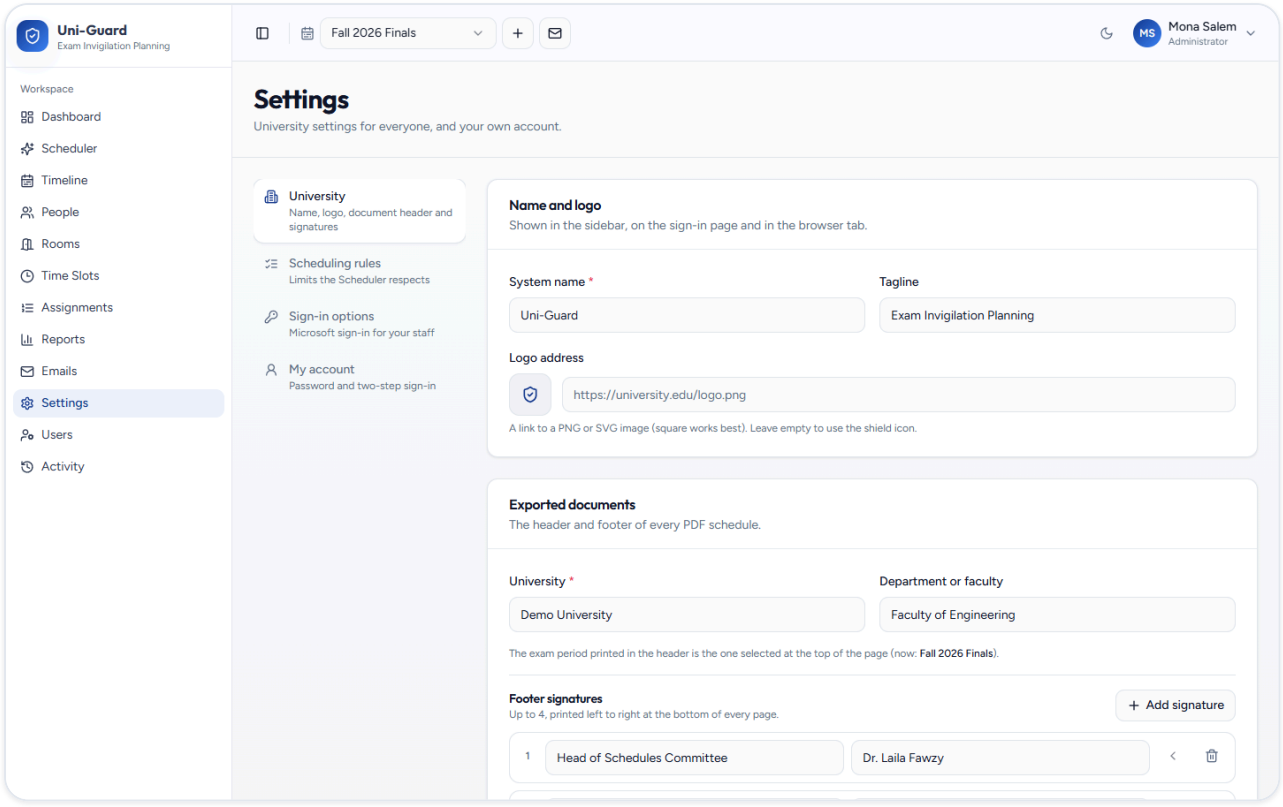
The Activity log

Emails (admins and schedulers) lists every email: waiting, sent, failed, or replaced by a newer version. Use **Send again** or **Send failed again** for failed schedule emails.



The Emails page

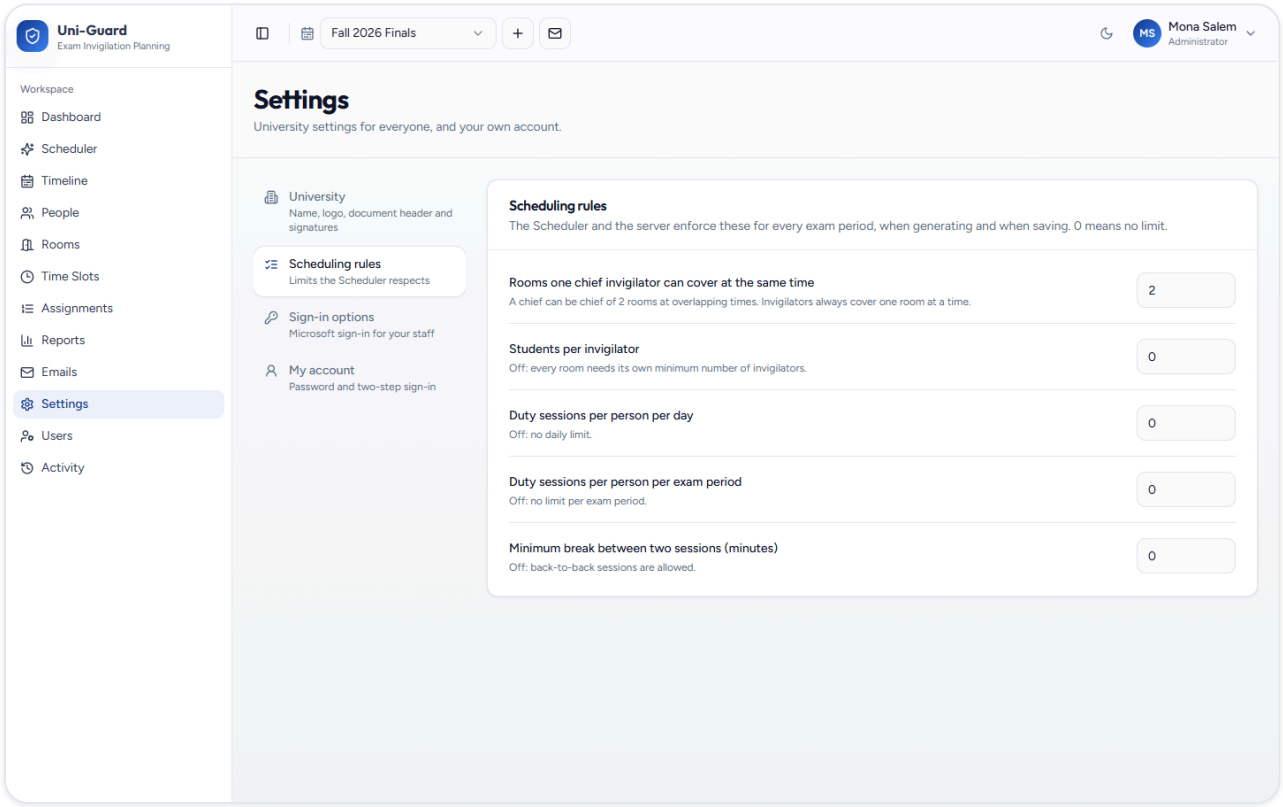
Admins change university settings for everyone. Changes stay on screen until you press **Save**; **Discard** undoes them.



Settings: University

- **Name and logo**: shown in the sidebar, sign-in page and browser tab.
- **Exported documents**: university and faculty printed on every PDF, plus the footer signatures, with a live preview.

Scheduling rules

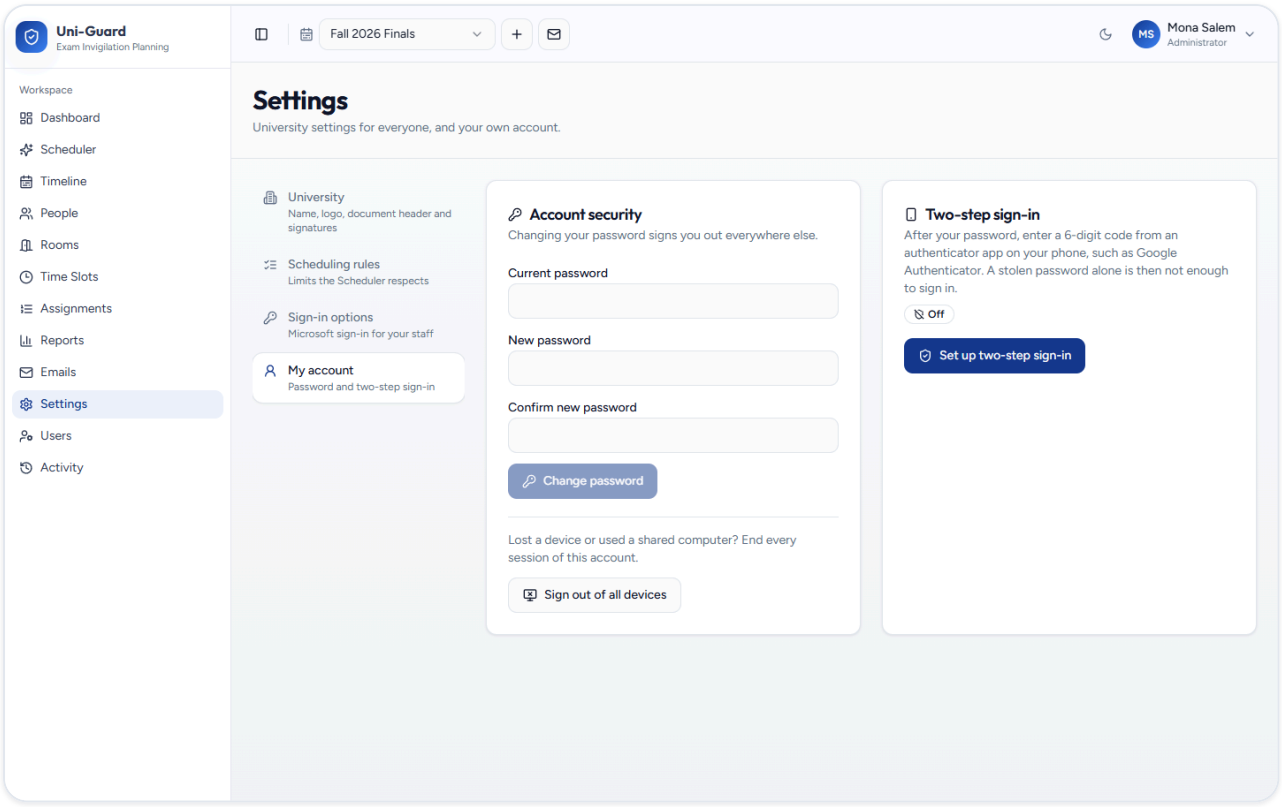


Settings: Scheduling rules

RULE	MEANING (0 = NO LIMIT)
Rooms one chief can cover at the same time	1 = one room each; 2 or more allows a shared chief
Students per invigilator	Big rooms get more invigilators automatically
Duty sessions per person per day	Most sittings one person can have on the same day
Duty sessions per person per exam period	Most sittings one person can have in the whole exam period
Minimum break between two sessions	Minutes of rest between two sittings of the same person

Sign-in options: type your university's Microsoft tenant id (from IT) so staff can use **Sign in with Microsoft**.

Open it from your name → **My account & security**.



Settings: My account

- **Change password**: current password, then the new one twice. Other devices are signed out.
- **Sign out of all devices**: for a lost device or a shared computer.
- **Connected accounts** (when Microsoft or Google sign-in is on): sign in without a password.

Two-step sign-in

1. Press **Set up two-step sign-in** and type your password.
2. Scan the code with Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, Authy or 1Password.
3. Type the 6-digit code and press **Switch on**.
4. Save your recovery codes, then press **I have saved them**.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
A person never appears in the list	Check their available days, leave, hall gender and subjects. They may also have reached a limit in Settings
A room shows Incomplete	Not enough free people. Add people, relax a limit, or pick someone by hand
A room shows Conflict	A rule is broken, for example one person in two rooms. Pick someone else
My Scheduler changes disappeared	You left before pressing Save. Save each slot (Ctrl+S)
Generate again changed rooms I liked	Lock those rooms, then use Regenerate unlocked
A staff member got no email	Check their email in People, then the Emails page
I see the wrong exams	Check the exam period in the top bar
I lost my authenticator phone	Use a recovery code, or ask an admin to remove two-step sign-in
Saving says someone is already assigned at an overlapping time	They have an exam at an overlapping time, maybe in another exam period. Pick someone else from the list
Room Allocation: an exam is yellow	Point at it. Either some students have no seat, or a Male/Female exam is in a Mixed hall. Set the right halls to Male / Female on the Rooms page, or leave Gender empty
Room Allocation: students without a seat	Read the hints under the exam: another time that day, switch a room back on, or add rooms